

■ By Kimi Dangor

Own a personal jet got a lot easier when "Flying Sikh" Manav Singh introduced Indians to Club One Air, a fractional ownership scheme on airplanes aimed at a breakfast in Bangalore, lunch in Mumbai and a dinner in Delhi crowd. Corporate chiefs, wary of rubbing shoulders with other frequent fliers, jumped at the chance of acquiring "part possession" of their very own flying machine. And even as the time-share scheme on airplanes has given Indians a new high, here comes a chance for the luxe list to crest a new wave with their very own luxury yacht.

While the jet, set, go bunch is crowding the private airplane circuit for their trips across the globe, there's a growing breed of intrepid leisure lappers, who prefer to chart their own course and drop anchor, albeit a gold-plated one. And yes, you don't need to shell out a few crores on a mega yacht to increase your party potential—just join an elite club.

An enterprising trio from Mumbai now gives you the chance to be part of a yacht club with a difference. The best part is you don't even have to



FLOATING GLORY:
A Larson Cabrio 350; its plush interiors (left); an inside view of Azimut 50 (bottom left)



THE CREST OF LUXURY

After time-share schemes on jets, luxury lappers can now get a taste of the yachting high life with a difference

own a 40-footer or even a tiny dinghy to qualify. Promoted by Jagdish Valecha, Ramesh Bulchandani and Rajesh Advani, Club Privada—Spanish for 'private affair'—is just that. It is an exclusive club where members can access a fully crewed and maintained luxury yacht—and the lifestyle that comes with it—for a fraction of the cost of owning and maintaining it. Born out of a desire to own a boat, the three avid sailing enthusiasts and fishing fanatics hit upon the idea of a yacht club to provide Indians with the ultimate cruise control experience. Says Karan Valecha, direc-

tor, Club Privada. "We have turned our passion into a business."

"People in India have the means but not necessarily the access to the leisure boating lifestyle. This will give people the chance to experience a luxury that, surprisingly, hasn't been offered before, given our country's ample coastline," adds Karan. Armed with a fleet of four boats—three Larson Cabrio 350 and one Azimut 50—Club Privada may have been launched on Mumbai waters as recently in mid-November, but pre-sale offers had already been pouring in and within a month, nearly 15 members have

come on board for the project. "We intend to keep the numbers down to preserve exclusivity. Membership will be limited to 70 on the current fleet of four," he says.

So if you have the bank balance for a spot of stress-free nautical activity, this may just be the perfect way to get to coastal destinations like Goa, Kashid, Shriwardhan, Ganapatipule and Murud Zanjira. "All issues, from dry docking, servicing, to maintenance, insurance, and crew arrangement, are handled by us. In fact, if you buy your own yacht, just the servicing and maintenance fees will cost you half our